

**NAME OF SCHOOL: MATER MISERICORDIAE SECONDARY SCHOOL,
RUMOMASI**

TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: SEVEN

CLASS: SS3

SUBJECT: Government

TOPIC: The United Nations (UN)

Introduction

- The United Nations is the world organisation of sovereign states, founded in 1945 (after the Second World War) to maintain international peace and security. It superseded the League of Nations.

Organs

- **General Assembly** — all members, one vote each, debates and recommends. **Security Council** — 15 members, 5 permanent with veto (USA, UK, France, Russia, China) and 10 elected; the only organ that can authorise sanctions and military action. **Secretariat** — the Secretary-General (Antonio Guterres) and the staff. **International Court of Justice** — the world court at The Hague. **Economic and Social Council** — development and human rights. **Trusteeship Council** — suspended.

Specialised agencies

- UNICEF (children), WHO (health), UNESCO (education, culture), FAO (food and agriculture), ILO (labour), IMF and the World Bank (finance), and UNDP (development) — all working in Nigeria on health, education and poverty.

Achievements and criticisms

- Achievements: peacekeeping, decolonisation, the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, humanitarian relief, the SDGs, conventions on the environment. Criticisms: the Security Council's veto, unequal power, slow action, and the financing of the organisation.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. When was the UN founded?
2. Name the five permanent members of the Security Council.
3. State the functions of the ICJ and UNICEF.
4. Give two achievements and two criticisms of the UN.

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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: EIGHT

CLASS: SS3

SUBJECT: Government

TOPIC: The African Union & The Commonwealth

Introduction

- The African Union (AU) is the continental body of Africa; the Commonwealth is the association of former British colonies. Nigeria is an active member of both.

The African Union

- Founded in 2002 (Addis Ababa) as the successor of the OAU (1963). Organs: the Assembly (heads of state), the Executive Council, the Commission, the Pan-African Parliament (Midrand), the Court of Justice, the Peace and Security Council, and the Economic, Social and Cultural Council. Objectives: unity and solidarity; peace and security (the African Standby Force); integration (the African Continental Free Trade Area); democracy and human rights; Agenda 2063. Nigeria's role: peacekeeping in Liberia, Sierra Leone and the stabilisation of the continent.

The Commonwealth

- A voluntary association of 56 states (the UK and its ex-colonies, plus Mozambique and Rwanda). The Commonwealth Heads of Government Meeting (CHOGM) meets every two years; the Commonwealth Secretariat (London) and the Commonwealth Fund for Technical Cooperation serve members; values: democracy, the rule of law, human rights and development; the Commonwealth Games promote friendship. Nigeria joined at independence (1960) and has hosted CHOGM and the games.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. When was the AU formed and what replaced?
2. State three objectives of the AU.
3. What is the Commonwealth?
4. Name three values of the Commonwealth.

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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: NINE

CLASS: SS3

SUBJECT: Government

TOPIC: Political Parties in Nigeria

Introduction

- A political party is an organised group that seeks to capture and control government through elections. Party politics in Nigeria has passed through eras: the nationalist parties, the First Republic parties, the military interludes, the Second Republic, and the current Fourth Republic parties.

Party history (selected)

- The NCNC (1944, Azikiwe — nationalist, later the East and parts of the West), the Action Group (1951, Awolowo — the West), the NPC (1951, Bello/Balewa — the North). The military banned parties (1966–1978); the Second Republic had five parties (NPN, UPN, NPP, GNPP, PRP — 1979); after the 1985 coup, two parties (NRC and SDP under Babangida — the annulment of June 12, 1993); the Fourth Republic (1999–) has been dominated by the PDP and the APC.

Functions and organisation

- Functions: interest articulation and aggregation, the nomination of candidates, electioneering, forming government or opposition, political education, and recruitment into leadership. Structure: the national convention, the national executive, state and local chapters, and the party's secretariat; internal democracy (primaries) chooses candidates — the source of many disputes (the party's inability to conduct credible primaries, defections and the 'godfather' problem).

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Define a political party.
2. Name the three parties of the First Republic and their leaders.
3. Which two parties have dominated the Fourth Republic?
4. State four functions of a political party.

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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: TEN

CLASS: SS3

SUBJECT: Government

TOPIC: Elections in Nigeria

Introduction

- Elections are the means by which the people choose their leaders. In Nigeria the Independent National Electoral Commission (INEC) conducts and supervises federal, state and local elections.

The electoral process

- Delimitation of constituencies; registration of voters; the display of the register; party primaries and the submission of candidates; election campaigns (regulated — no violence, hate speech or the use of state resources); accreditation (with the card reader/bimodal voter accreditation system); voting by secret ballot; counting and collation; the declaration of results; and election petitions (tribunals and the courts).

The electoral system

- The first-past-the-post (simple majority) system; the presidential election requires a majority of votes cast and at least 25% in two-thirds of the states; the system is designed to give a spread (federal character) rather than a sectional mandate.

Problems and reforms

- Problems: rigging, vote buying, thuggery, the Bimodal Voter Accreditation System (BVAS) failures, the electronic transmission of results, insecurity, the scarcity of polling materials, the annulment of results and court cases. Reforms: the card reader and BVAS, the iRev (result viewing) portal, continuous voter registration, the Electoral Act 2022 (e-transmission, the extension of the result declaration window), and voter education.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Define an election.
2. List the stages of the electoral process.
3. What is the Bimodal Voter Accreditation System?
4. State four problems of Nigerian elections.

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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: ELEVEN

CLASS: SS3

SUBJECT: Government

TOPIC: Problems of Nigerian Governance

Introduction

- Governance is the manner in which power is exercised in managing a country's affairs. Nigeria's governance problems are the recurring themes of the exam: corruption, ethnicity, electoral malpractice, poor institutions and service delivery.

The problems

- **Corruption** — embezzlement, bribery, contract inflation, budget padding; the costs: diverted development funds, poor services, and a bad image (the reasons for EFCC, ICPC and the CCB). **Ethnicity and religion** — the use of ethnic and religious loyalty in politics; quota and federal character disputes. **Electoral malpractice** — rigging and vote buying, undermining the legitimacy of government. **Weak institutions** — an inefficient civil service, the delay of justice, police inadequacy and insecurity (banditry, kidnapping, insurgency). **Service delivery** — poor power, roads, health and water.

Consequences

- Under-development, poverty and inequality; unemployment and the brain drain; low foreign investment; a trust deficit between the government and the people; and a weakened national image — all of which feed the cycle of poor governance.

Solutions

- The rule of law and an independent judiciary; the enforcement of anti-corruption laws and asset recovery; transparent budgets and procurement (the Due Process and BPP); electoral reform and credible elections; true federalism and devolution; investment in education and the civil service; civic education; and leaders who accept accountability.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Define governance.
2. State four problems of Nigerian governance.
3. How does corruption affect development?
4. Mention three measures for improving governance.

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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: TWELVE

CLASS: SS3

SUBJECT: Government

TOPIC: Pressure Groups & Civil Society

Introduction

- A pressure group is an organized body that seeks to influence government policy without seeking to capture government itself — unlike a political party. Civil society is the arena of these voluntary associations outside the state and the market.

Types of pressure groups

- **Sectional (interest) groups** — promote the interests of their members: the Nigeria Labour Congress (NLC) and the Trade Union Congress (workers), the Academic Staff Union of Universities (ASUU — lecturers), the Manufacturers Association of Nigeria (MAN — industry), the Nigerian Association of Chambers of Commerce, Industry, Mines and Agriculture (NACCIMA — business), the Nigeria Bar Association (lawyers), the Nigerian Medical Association (doctors), the Nigeria Union of Journalists (the press), the market women associations, the farmers' bodies, and the ethnic and cultural associations.

Methods of influence

- Lobbying and briefing sessions; dialogue and consultation with ministries and the legislature; strikes and industrial action (the NLC); demonstrations and protests; litigation (the courts); the use of the media and public opinion; electioneering support; and the threat of withdrawal of cooperation.

Importance and criticisms

- Importance: they articulate interests; educate the public on issues; check the abuse of power; provide expert advice; and give citizens a channel of participation between elections. Criticisms: some are sectional and selfish; some are violent or partisan; the big unions can hold the economy to ransom; and some groups serve foreign interests rather than the nation.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Define a pressure group.
2. Differentiate a pressure group from a political party.
3. Name three sectional pressure groups in Nigeria.

4. State four methods used by pressure groups.
5. Give two criticisms of pressure groups.